JOSEPH UGALDE

SOLUTIONS & DELIVERY LEADER

B2B SAAS | CLOUD-NATIVE SOFTWARE | CROSS-FUNCTIONAL LEADERSHIP | TECHNICAL PROGRAM MANAGEMENT

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Technical delivery leader who bridges engineering and business to ship complex B2B SaaS products. Background spans data engineering, software development, cloud architecture, and cybersecurity — with enterprise delivery at IBM and HPE and end-to-end P&L ownership at a growth-stage SaaS company. Proven track record in building and scaling distributed teams, driving platform modernization, and leading implementations from scoping through go-live.
Certifications: PMP | CSM | CSPO | CompTIA Pentest+ | Azure | RPA

SKILLS

- Leadership: Cross-functional Teams, Distributed Delivery, P&L Ownership, Team Scaling, Technical Program Management, Stakeholder Management
- Technical: Cloud-Native SaaS, Platform Modernization, API/ERP Integration, Data Engineering, Solutions Architecture, AI-Assisted Development, Security Assessment, DevSecOps, CI/CD
- Methodologies: Agile, Scrum, Kanban, Continuous Improvement

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Feb 2022 - Present

Software Solution Manager - Development & Technical Delivery, Systems X

- Led end-to-end rebuild of cross-border compliance platform (Mexico-US electronic invoicing and accounting); inherited initiative with no documentation, reverse-engineered legacy system, owned 24-month roadmap, and directed 8,000+ hour delivery project.
- Transformed business model from licensed desktop software to multi-tenant SaaS subscription; built pricing model based on vCores, users, and transaction volume; projected profitability within 13 months of full legacy customer migration.
- Built technical department from 1 to 10 (5 direct engineers + 5 contractors across LATAM, Europe, Asia); designed org structure, established DevOps function, and led distributed Scrum team as player-coach across engineering, QA, architecture, and client delivery.
- Introduced AI-assisted development tools (Claude Code and Cursor) into team workflow; trained engineers on effective prompting, accelerating POC delivery and expanding team capacity without additional headcount.
- Reduced ERP integration costs from $20K to $4K by replacing paid API deployments with ODBC + stored procedure architecture for the development stage; coded bidirectional Plex ERP integration, eliminating manual data transfers between systems.
- Managed $300K project budget; designed Azure architecture (App Services, Functions, SQL, Blob Storage), built CI/CD pipeline with GitHub Actions, and optimized cloud spend through right-sizing and logical server architecture.
- Reduced client onboarding time by 62% (8 months → 3 months) using AI-assisted Jira analysis and Agile retrospectives to identify bottlenecks and restructure implementation sequencing.
- Maintained hands-on security practice alongside delivery leadership; conducted repository assessments using GitLeaks, performed firewall and access audits, and implemented preventive measures, including Azure Key Vault and pre-commit secret scanning.

Cybersecurity Engineer, Penetration Tester, MICIT **Sep 2021 - Feb 2022**

- Scoped and executed 4 penetration testing engagements for Costa Rican government institutions during a period of heightened cyber threat monitoring; drafted SOW, Rules of Engagement, and NDAs aligned with NIST SP 800-115.

- Conducted reconnaissance using OSINT tools (Shodan, theHarvester) and active enumeration (Nmap, Wireshark); performed manual assessments with Burp Suite and OpenVAS, prioritizing findings by CVSS score for critical and high-severity vulnerabilities.
- Delivered executive and technical reports mapped to MITRE ATT&CK framework to government leadership and institution IT teams; findings led to immediate remediation, including closure of exposed internet-facing ports and credentials.

Application Developer, Custom Development & Automation, IBM Consulting **Feb 2018 - Aug 2021**

- Delivered automation solutions for IBM Global Consulting as part of a formal Kaizen continuous improvement program; partnered with teams across the US, Europe, and Asia to identify workflow bottlenecks and ship high-impact applications.
- Owned full SDLC, requirements gathering, architecture, development, testing, and release, working in two-week Scrum sprints with all ceremonies; collected requirements directly from internal clients.
- Shipped 20+ full-stack applications using Python, Django, and Bootstrap; solutions ranged from multi-user web forms replacing email workflows to data processing pipelines integrated with Jira and internal IBM systems.
- Replaced manual spreadsheet workflows with data-driven web apps and interactive dashboards (Pandas, NumPy, Plotly); NPS surveys documented 150K+ labor hours reclaimed annually across supported organizations.
- Designed and optimized data layers (SQL Server, MySQL, PostgreSQL); created new databases for applications and improved query performance through index optimization on existing systems.

Automation and Analytics Manager, IBM Consulting **Aug 2014 - Jan 2018**

- Scaled analytics department from 8 to 20 direct reports, hiring data, software, and industrial engineers; supported 50 consulting practices across 8 business units in North America.
- Partnered with Directors, VPs, and Partners across IBM Services North America; developed Power BI dashboards and data models for hiring decisions, revenue forecasting, resource allocation, and financial reporting — enabling tracking of SLAs, OKRs, and KPIs.
- Led automation initiatives using SQL, VBA, and RPA, supporting all of IBM Consulting North America. Documented savings of thousands of labor hours annually.
- Implemented ETL pipelines and OLAP cubes to build data warehouses; streamlined reporting capabilities across multiple business units
- Managed 20 direct reports with monthly 1:1s focused on career development and performance; developed a successor who was promoted to Manager upon transition.

Project Manager, Hewlett Packard Enterprise (HPE) **Feb 2011 - Jul 2014**

- Solved persistent Java incompatibility issue blocking use of standard HP systems; led root cause analysis, built business case, secured budget, executed POC for leadership, and migrated 200+ PCs from client OS to HP Windows. Won multiple awards for project impact.
- Led migration of 100-FTE accounts payable operation from client facility to HP building; completed full transition over a single weekend with zero service disruption.
- Designed reporting cadence for accounts payable operations serving Procter & Gamble across three teams (60 FTEs); reports triggered operational actions that improved document payment rates by approximately 20%.
- Delivered weekly executive briefings on project status and SLA performance to BPO leadership; escalated critical cases and enabled faster decisions on hiring and resource allocation.

EDUCATION

MBA, Cybersecurity – Penetration Tester

MBA, Project Management

Bachelor of Business Administration